Reading Signed in Advance: a guide for a team

PSYCHE

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Signed in Advance (57 pages, October 2026) describes how a delivered compute hour becomes a record two contracting parties can rely on, and who may turn that record into a binding outcome. Its companion, SQCD-1, is the open standard the record follows. Both are at psyche-0.com.

No single reader covers the whole paper. A contracts lawyer, a finance lead, a telemetry engineer and a security reviewer each own part of it, and one person joins their answers. This guide says who reads what, and how the team checks that its answers agree.

Five things everyone on the team should know

1. **Sigma states what the evidence supports.** It evaluates a Claim and its sealed evidence against a standard both parties fixed before delivery, and returns one of four results. It says nothing about ground truth and settles nothing (§5.3, §7.5).
2. **Only a signature accepts.** A Case reaches `accepted` only on a review signed by the party the Claim binds, or by its delegate inside a bounded, revocable grant (§1.1, §6.3).
3. **Silence costs what was signed in advance.** If the reviewing party says nothing, the Case ends `expired` under one of four forms both parties chose when they opened it. Silence never produces `accepted` (§5.7, §6.10).
4. **The record and the money are separate.** A terminal state fixes the record. Money moves outside PSYCHE, on the payer's own authorization, and a `disputed` Case leaves the amount to a resolution outside the record (§1.1, §5.4, §7.7).
5. **The evidence so far is synthetic.** §6 states the properties with their proofs, and §9 tests the implementation on 1,760 generated Cases. No dispute between real parties has been run through it yet (§10.4).

§1.4 of the paper walks one Case through all five.

One Case, stage by stage

Stage	What happens	Leads	Checks	Paper	SQCD-1
T0 Opening	Both parties sign the arming: the Profile's digest, the deadline, the review window, the expiry form and the credit terms	Contracts	Finance, Security	§5.7, §7.2	Annex 2.4, Annex 8
T1 Delivery	Each side files its own signed series; gaps are declared	Measurement	Audit	§2.1, §7.3	B, C, D
T2 Sealing	The gate admits evidence and seals it into a PoR Capsule; a holder of the full ReplayBundle can recompute the Sigma result	Measurement	Security, Audit	§7.3, §7.4, §6.11	D, E, H
T3 Evaluation	Sigma returns one of four results	Measurement	Security	§7.5, §9	none
T4 Decision	The bound party signs accept, reject or dispute, or says nothing	Contracts	Security	§5.6, §6.3, §7.6	F2, I.1.1
T5 Final state	The log folds to `accepted`, `rejected`, `disputed`, `expired` or `withdrawn`	Security	Contracts	§5.3, §6.3, §6.10	I.1
T6 Money	The delivery Case releases the invoice or does not; a credit is priced on a Case of its own; the payer authorizes any payment	Finance	Contracts	§7.7, §5.7	Annex 2.4, I.1
T7 Third parties	A lender or auditor reads the record under a disclosure grant and refolds its state	Finance (credit)	Audit, Contracts	§7.2	K3, K5

A reader under a disclosure grant checks the signed record and refolds each Case's state. Recomputing the Sigma result takes the full ReplayBundle, evidence payloads included, and access to those is a separate question of disclosure (§6.11, §7.2).

Who reads what

Contracts and law. Read in full: §1.1, §1.4, §5.1, §5.6, §5.7, §7.6, §10.3, §10.6, and the statements of Theorems 1 and 6 (§6.3, §6.10). In SQCD-1: Annex 2.4, F2, I.1, K3, K5, Annex 8. Answers: who signs, under what authority, and what silence costs in this contract. Cannot settle alone: whether a given jurisdiction enforces the expiry form.

Finance. Read in full: §1, §1.4, §2.2, §2.3, §5.4, §7.2, §7.7, §9.3, §9.4, §10.4. In SQCD-1: Annex 2.4, I.1, Annex 3. Answers: which state releases which amount, and what can be recomputed without the other party. In a lender, payables and credit risk usually sit with different people; both read this list, and credit adds §2.4 and §11.

Compute measurement. Read in full: §1.4, §2.1, §5.1, §7.2 to §7.4, §9.5, §10.1, §10.9. In SQCD-1: B, C, D, H. Answers: what each side must file, when, in what form, and what to sign when data is missing. Cannot settle alone: what a gap costs, which is a contract term.

Security and audit. Read in full: §1.2, §3, §6, §7.8, §9.1, §9.2, §10.5, §10.7 to §10.10, and §4 with §6.13 for how the design differs from settling on a verdict. Answers: what still holds if PSYCHE itself misbehaves, what can be proved to a third party, and what rests on the participant registry, observer clocks and the keys the hosted deployment holds. An auditor focused on assurance can stop after §6.11 and §6.12.

The person who joins the answers. Read §1, §5, §7, §10 and §11, then each specialist's notes. Owns the end-to-end trace of one Case and the list of what is still open.

Five questions the team answers together

Each answer cites a section of the paper or a clause of SQCD-1.

1. Can `claim-supported` alone make a Case `accepted`? Whose signature would?
2. The two parties' figures for the same channel diverge. What does the record show, and who decides?
3. The customer says nothing. What state does the Case reach, and what does the contract then owe under the form it chose?
4. The customer is owed a credit. On which Case is it priced, by whom, and what has to happen before money moves?
5. A lender reads the record. What can it check without either party, and what does it still need from them?

The team understands the paper when each member answers these the same way and can name one assumption that someone else on the team has to confirm.

For a GPU cloud

Who reads: the head of contracts (Contracts), the revenue and credits lead (Finance), the SRE or telemetry lead (Compute measurement), the CISO (Security).

The question to answer first: can we file what the Profile requires, from the telemetry we already collect, signed and on time?

Start with §1.4, §7.3 and SQCD-1 Section C. Then decide the expiry form and the credit terms with the customer before the first window opens.

For a lender

Who reads: the credit analyst (Finance), counsel (Contracts), the technical adviser (Compute measurement with Security).

The question to answer first: can this record serve as a draw condition or covenant evidence, and what can we verify without the borrower's cooperation?

Start with §7.2, §7.7 and §5.4, then SQCD-1 K3 and K5. A grant from either contracting party opens the record, and the contract's confidentiality terms decide whether one party's grant is enough. What you read under a grant stays checkable in your hands. A grant opens the signed record without the evidence payloads, so you refold each Case's state yourself and read its Sigma result as recorded.

For a rating agency

Who reads: the lead analyst (Finance), the surveillance analyst (Finance), a technical reviewer (Security).

The question to answer first: which events in the record bear on the facilities we rate, and how quickly would we see them?

Start with §1.4, §5.4, §7.2 and §10.4. The record carries every acceptance, expiry, divergence and dispute with its signer and time, and a reader under a grant receives it Case by Case (§7.2).

For an investor

Who reads: the partner (the person who joins the answers), a technical adviser (Security).

The question to answer first: what is new here, and what is still unproved?

Start with the Abstract, §1, §5.2, §6.13 and §12, then §10.4 and §11. The paper states properties of a design with their proofs and tests an implementation on generated Cases. Real disputes, legal enforceability and commercial uptake are still to be shown.